

Week 3 Packet

YOU SOUP Recipe



Ingredients:

base & broth

- race
- ethnicity
- gender
- sexuality
- disability status



early additions

- socioeconomic status
- geographic location
- education
- family structure



optional

- hobbies & passions
- religion & faith
- career
- political beliefs



secret ingredients

- personal experiences
- changes to other ingredients
- hidden identities
- misperception of ingredients



Procedure:

Combine base ingredients to create broth and bring to a boil. Add early additions and simmer over low heat for 18 - 25 years, adding optional and secret ingredients to taste. Makes one You.

What's Your "You Soup"?

Please think about all of the ingredients that converge together to make you, and use that knowledge to guide your responses to the questions below.

Base and Broth (*What social or cultural identities "flavor" all of your experiences from the very beginning?*):

Race (social) = _____

Ethnicity (social) = _____

Gender (social) = _____

Sexuality (social) = _____

Ability Status (social) = _____

Other: _____

***Consider:** Which of your base & broth ingredients give you privilege in some spaces and make you vulnerable in others?*

Early Additions: (*What additional factors inform your context throughout your life?*):

Socioeconomic Status (social): _____

Geographic Location (personal): _____

Education (personal): _____

Family Structure (personal): _____

Cultural Influences: _____

Other: _____

***Consider:** Which of your early additions shaped your beliefs and how you perceive the world around you?*

Garnishes: (*What are some "add-ons" that may echo your base, broth, and early additions? These can be from pre-college experiences or more recent values and decisions*)

Political beliefs (personal): _____

Religion and Faith (social): _____

Values: _____

Goals and Aspirations (personal): _____

Hidden Identities (personal) = _____

Misperceptions (personal; extra seasonings others add to your soup — flavors you didn't choose or that don't always reflect who you are): _____

Other: _____

Consider: *What garnishes represent intention in your identity?*

Story Exchange Activity: Sharing our stories together and developing our perspective taking skills

Before you begin, take a moment to reflect:

- What is important for your ALA 240 peers to know about you? Quickly and briefly list 5-8 things that truly tell the story of who you are today because of your YouSoup exploration.

Instructions — in pairs

1. Introduce yourself to a partner highlighting the most important facets of who you are.
***Share only details that you feel safe sharing with others and hearing out loud in small groups.*
2. Listen to your partner introduce themselves. What did they share with you that is important to convey to others?
3. Introduce your partner to your desk group using first person, e.g, if you were partnered with Alan, you will say "Hi, I'm Alan..."
4. Group Debrief

Reflection Questions: Intersection of Identities and Wellbeing

1. What are some of your hot and cold spots?
 - a. **Hot Spots** = identities where you experience more privilege/power
 - b. **Cold Spots** = identities where you experience marginalization or barriers
2. How does the foundation of your identity and lived experiences (base and broth) shape your perspectives on wellbeing, identity, and how you move through the world—particularly in the present moment?
3. In what ways have your social location and systemic influences (e.g., socioeconomic status, race, gender, education level) impacted your formative experiences with healthcare, including access to mental and physical health resources?
4. Have the intersections of your early experiences and privileges influenced your attitudes toward health and wellness? If so, how? (For example, who do you believe health and wellness is for? How do you perceive self-care—as a necessity or a luxury?)
5. How did your “garnishes” influence your perspectives, contemporary healthcare experiences, and attitudes towards health and wellness?
6. How does perception impact or show up in your “soup”?

Exploring Mental Health: What is your experience with the continuum of mental health and flourishing?

